

AMMAR AHMED SHAIKH

Network Engineer | QA Engineer (Freelance) | SOC / Blue Team Transition
Hyderabad, India | +91 77026 49756 | shaikhammar20@outlook.com
linkedin.com/in/ammarahmedshaikh | github.com/Shaiikhammar29

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

IT and Network Engineering professional with 2+ years of hands-on experience in network administration, system monitoring, and technical support across enterprise and service-provider environments. Skilled in routing and switching, firewall management, VPN configuration, and network monitoring using platforms such as SolarWinds. Concurrently delivers freelance software QA and test automation for client projects, bringing 2 years of hands-on quality assurance experience and currently taking on new engagements. CCNP Enterprise, Fortinet, and Microsoft Azure certified, with a consistent record of maintaining high system uptime and resolving complex network issues. Currently developing blue team security operations skills with a view to a SOC Analyst or Security Engineer role.

CORE SKILLS

Networking: LAN/WAN Technologies, Routing & Switching, Network Security, Network Troubleshooting, Bandwidth Management

Tools & Platforms: SolarWinds, Fortinet Firewalls, VPN (IPsec/SSL), Microsoft Azure (IAM, Monitoring & Logging, Backup & Disaster Recovery)

Quality Assurance: Manual and automated testing, functional/regression/integration testing, test planning and case design, defect tracking, API testing

Programming & Scripting: Python, MySQL, HTML5, CSS, JavaScript

Soft Skills: Effective Time Management, Communication, Collaboration & Teamwork, Active Listening

SECURITY SKILLS — IN DEVELOPMENT

Certification-backed and lab-based. Not yet applied in a production security environment.

SIEM & Log Monitoring: Wazuh, Splunk, log ingestion and parsing, alert tuning and false-positive reduction

Endpoint & Log Analysis: Windows Security event logs, Sysmon telemetry, Linux authentication and audit logs

Detection Frameworks: MITRE ATT&CK, Sigma rule authoring, Cyber Kill Chain

Network Security Monitoring: Wireshark, Zeek, Suricata, PCAP analysis

Incident Response: NIST SP 800-61 lifecycle, triage and escalation workflows, incident reporting

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Engineer (Freelance)

2024 – Present

Independent / Contract | Hyderabad, India (remote)

- Deliver manual and automated software testing for client web and application projects, covering functional, regression, and integration testing across release cycles.
- Design and execute test plans, test cases, and test data; log, triage, and track defects through to closure in [Jira / Azure DevOps], working directly with client developers to reproduce and verify fixes.
- Build automated test scripts in Python [/ Selenium / pytest / Playwright], reducing manual regression effort across repeat release cycles.
- Perform API testing and validation [using Postman], verifying request and response handling, error states, authentication, and data integrity.
- Produce test summary reports and release sign-off recommendations, giving clients a clear quality and risk assessment ahead of deployment.
- Manage scope, timelines, and client communication independently as a contractor — currently available for and actively taking on new projects.

Replace the bracketed tool names with the tools you actually use, and confirm the start year.

Network Engineer

Dec 2024 – Dec 2025

REDF (Real Estate Development Fund) | Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

- Monitored network alerts and system health using the SolarWinds platform, maintaining continuous uptime across 43 branch servers throughout Saudi Arabia.
- Identified and troubleshoot network and server issues, with particular focus on storage-related incidents within virtual machines, escalating to Mobily support for timely resolution.
- Conducted connectivity diagnostics, including ping tests and packet loss analysis, to ensure stable internet and intranet performance.
- Assessed and reported on bandwidth usage, internet availability, and performance metrics using Mobily's monitoring platform.
- Prepared and maintained weekly reports covering system incidents, bandwidth utilisation, and storage upgrade activities.
- Coordinated with the Mobily team on bandwidth upgrades and storage expansions, ensuring timely implementation with minimal disruption.
- Served as the primary communication link between internal technical teams and external service providers to resolve infrastructure issues effectively.

Network Engineer

Jun 2023 – Feb 2024

NourNet | Riyadh, Saudi Arabia — Remote (based in Hyderabad, India)

- Implemented and maintained network infrastructure for multiple clients, ensuring high availability and optimal performance through advanced routing and switching techniques.
- Managed and configured Fortinet firewalls at an associate level, including firewall policies, NAT, and VPN setup.
- Established secure site-to-site and remote-access VPNs using IPsec and SSL protocols to protect data across multiple client locations.
- Diagnosed and resolved VPN connectivity issues, improving user experience and data security.
- Conducted regular security audits and updates to maintain network integrity.
- Resolved network connectivity issues reported by end users, ensuring prompt resolution with minimal disruption.
- Monitored and managed bandwidth usage to ensure equitable distribution and prevent network congestion.
- Documented troubleshooting processes, configuration changes, and resolutions to support knowledge sharing and future reference.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Cisco Certified Network Professional (CCNP) Enterprise — Cisco
- Cisco Certified Specialist – Enterprise Core (ENCOR) — Cisco
- Cisco Certified Specialist – Enterprise Advanced Routing and Services (ENARSI) — Cisco
- Fortinet NSE SD-WAN 7.2 Architect — Fortinet
- Fortinet Certified Associate, Cybersecurity — Fortinet
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Administrator Associate (AZ-104) — Microsoft

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering (B.E.), Information Technology

2019 – 2023

Osmania University | Hyderabad, Telangana, India

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- Availability: open to 24x7 rotational shifts, on-site, hybrid, and relocation.